

Asia. A key driver of this growth is demographic change, alongside increasing purchasing power,” says Shreshtha Jana, General Manager at L’Oréal Luxe India.

ACCORDING TO World Data Lab, India’s base of affluent consumers has expanded from 10 million in 2022 to 19 million in 2025, and is projected to hit 39 million by 2030. “This rising affluent population represents the fundamental growth engine for the luxury beauty segment,” says Jana.

Estée Lauder is targeting 60 million Indian women through digital micro-segmentation, tie-ups with fashion designer Sabyasachi, and investments in brands like Forest Essentials, which specialises in Ayurvedic beauty products.

Japan’s Shiseido, with a history of more than 150 years, has brought its NARS brand to India via Nykaa, and plans to boost its brand presence in the subcontinent.

South Korea’s Amorepacific Corp. is popularising K-beauty rituals in the country. Korean skincare has moved from niche to mainstream, with sheet masks, essences and serums now common in Indian make-up routines.

Louis Vuitton’s latest make-up collection has already taken luxury beauty to the next level with its lipsticks and lip balms, and eyeshadow palettes starting at \$250. Refills for the lipsticks are available for \$69 while eyeshadow refills cost \$92.

Imports mirror the trend. Cosmetics and skincare product imports have more than doubled from \$80.9 million in FY20 to \$171.9 million in FY25, says the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

At Nykaa, luxury beauty is now one of the fastest-growing product categories. Anchit Nayar, Executive Director and Chief Executive Officer of Nykaa Beauty, explains, “The world’s leading beauty brands are placing bold bets on India, which is now firmly positioned as

YSL STORE

Part of L’Oréal’s luxury beauty division, YSL has free-standing stores across the country. Pictured here is the one at Mall of Asia, Bengaluru.



“India’s luxury beauty journey is being redefined by a powerful intersection of quality products, digital influence, and a renewed commitment to self-expression and self-care”

ANANYA BIRLA

FOUNDER AND MANAGING DIRECTOR OF BIRLA COSMETICS PVT LTD